

notes

Taking notes in class...

Markdown → PDF (macOS)

This repo uses `md-to-pdf` (headless Chromium) plus `pdf-theme.css` so exports look clean on paper: system fonts, readable code blocks, and sensible margins.

Setup (once)

1. Install `Node.js` (LTS is fine), which includes `npm`.
2. In this folder:

```
npm install
```

Commands

Command	What it does
<code>npm run pdf -- path/to/note.md</code>	Writes <code>path/to/note.pdf</code> next to the Markdown file.
<code>npm run pdf -- a.md b.md</code>	Converts several files in one go.
<code>npm run pdf:watch -- path/to/note.md</code>	Rebuilds the PDF whenever that file changes (stop with Ctrl+C).

Examples:

```
npm run pdf -- README.md
npm run pdf -- ./lectures/week3.md
npm run pdf:watch -- ./lectures/week3.md
```

PDF-only text transforms

Before conversion, `scripts/md2pdf.mjs` adjusts prose (not fenced ````` code): English Greek letter names → Unicode (e.g. `sigma` / `Sigma` → σ / Σ), and caret exponents → superscript HTML (`x^2` , `x^{n+1}` → rendered powers). `[^...]` footnote markers and `\^` escapes are left alone.

Styling the PDF

Edit `pdf-theme.css` at the project root. The script always applies that stylesheet on top of the HTML that `md-to-pdf` generates from your Markdown.

Use normal CSS aimed at **print**: `@page` margins, `body` typography, `pre / code`, `table`, `blockquote`, etc. After changes, run `npm run pdf -- your-file.md` again.

Markdown commands for styling

Below is a concise reference for what you can write in `.md` files. The converter uses **Marked** with GitHub-flavored Markdown-style features (tables, task lists, strikethrough, etc.).

Headings

```
# Largest title
## Section
### Subsection
#### Smaller heading
```

Use more `#` symbols for deeper levels (up to six levels with `#####`).

Emphasis

You write	Result
<code>**bold**</code> or <code>__bold__</code>	bold
<code>*italic*</code> or <code>_italic_</code>	<i>italic</i>
<code>***bold italic***</code>	<i>bold italic</i>
<code>~~strikethrough~~</code>	strikethrough (GFM)

Paragraphs and line breaks

- One blank line starts a new paragraph.
- End a line with **two spaces** before the newline, or use a **backslash** at end of line, for a soft line break inside a paragraph.

Lists

Bulleted:

```
- Item one
- Item two
  - Nested item
```

Numbered:

1. First
2. Second
 1. Nested step

Links and images

```
[Link text](https://example.com)
![Description of image](./figures/diagram.png)
```

Paths to images are resolved relative to the **Markdown file's folder**, which helps for lecture assets next to your notes.

Code

Inline: ``const x = 1``

Fenced block with optional language for highlighting:

```
```javascript
function hello(name) {
 return `Hello, ${name}`;
}
```
```

Blockquotes

```
> Important definition or quote.
> Multiple lines can continue with `>`.
```

Horizontal rule

```
---
```

(or `***` on its own line)

Tables (GFM)

| Column A | Column B |
|----------|----------|
| foo | bar |
| baz | qux |

Alignment: `|:---|` left, `|:---:|` center, `---:|` right.

Task lists (GFM)

- ☐ Todo item
- ☒ Done item

Escaping

Prefix special characters with `\` when you want them literally, e.g. `\*not italic\*`.